

Vincent Walker

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior Software Engineer with 7+ years of experience architecting scalable web applications within fast-paced startups. Expert in the Ruby on Rails ecosystem, React.js, and Hotwire, with a proven track record of engineering high-quality, maintainable codebases across the full product lifecycle. Experienced collaborating with cross-functional, international teams to drive technical roadmaps and deliver impactful features. Currently seeking a senior full-stack or Rails-focused engineering role (permanent or contract), bringing a unique combination of deep technical ownership and commercial awareness developed across two careers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

❖ AWS / Heroku	❖ Ruby on Rails	❖ React.js	❖ Stimulus.js	❖ Turbo	❖ Tailwind
❖ Redis / Sidekiq	❖ PostgreSQL	❖ Solid queue	❖ Solid cache	❖ Docker	❖ CI/CD

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- ❖ **Engineering Leadership:** Rapidly evolved from a self-taught background to architecting complex, production-grade Ruby on Rails applications, demonstrating a high degree of technical adaptability and continuous learning.
- ❖ **System Optimisation(Boilerjuice):** Engineered a high-performance dynamic site-reporting tool that utilized AWS DynamoDB for real-time data ingestion, directly improving the operational visibility for CS agents and on-site engineers.
- ❖ **Architecture & Security (Mercantiworld):** Independently architected a full-stack SaaS MVP using Rails 8 and Hotwire integrating multi-provider payment gateways (Stripe/Braintree) and AWS (Elastic beanstalk, S3, Lightsail). Verified system resilience through rigorous smoke and stress testing to ensure production readiness
- ❖ **Global Scaling (Scan.com):** Key contributor to the core engineering team that designed and deployed a nationwide B2B scheduling platform for the US market, managing complex multi-portal permissions for Admin, Legal, and Healthcare users.
- ❖ **Process Improvement (King & McGaw):** Significantly enhanced application stability by implementing automated testing suites, increasing code coverage and reducing regression cycles during the transition to Rails 6.1.

CAREER SUMMARY

FOUNDER & LEAD ENGINEER - MERCANTIWORLD *July 2025 - Present*

- Independently designed and launched a Rails 8 + Hotwire e-commerce platform from the ground up, maintaining this as an ongoing personal project while returning to full-time employment.
- Architected scalable AWS infrastructure (Elastic Beanstalk, S3), integrated multi-provider payment gateways (Stripe/Braintree), and validated production readiness through smoke and stress testing.
- Deepened expertise in Rails 8, Solid Queue, Solid Cache, and modern full-stack architecture through end-to-end product ownership.
- Transitioned to a side project.

PRODUCT ENGINEER [SCAN.COM](#) (US ENGINEERING TEAM) *November 2022 – July 2025*

- Collaborated closely with the US product team to develop the new US B2B platform, creating and implementing features across dedicated portals for Admins, Referring Providers, and Attorneys.
- Collaborated on the development of a new software assessment tool for Traumatic Brain Injury (TBI)
- Built front end features using React, Turbo Frames, Turbo Streams, and Stimulus.js

FULL STACK RUBY ON RAILS DEVELOPER – BOILERJUICE *July 2021 – November - 2022*

- Created and brought to life a dynamic form that involved both backend as well as front end development, this can be used by an Engineer on site, on submission of this form the data is stored in a Postgres (Heroku) database as well as synced on company dashboards using several API calls as well as using AWS Dynamo DB to store payloads.
- Supported team in managing the Customer Services Help Desk that require engineer support

RUBY ON RAILS DEVELOPER – KING AND MCGAW *February 2021 – July 2021*

- Developing, improving and maintaining the main retail site working with Rails(6.1) as well as Vue.js and Tailwind CSS on the front end
- Increased testing coverage from 40% to 85% using RSpec, significantly reducing production bugs.

BUSINESS SYSTEMS DEVELOPER- HOSTELLING INTERNATIONAL *June 2019 - November 2020*

- Updated the Front-end views, on the current platform leading to an overall improved user experience (www.hihostels.com)
 - Using Ruby, HTML, CSS (Bootstrap) and JavaScript, edited and amended the site to match organisations Brand Guidelines

CAREER TRANSITION INTO SOFTWARE ENGINEERING 2017 – 2019

Self-directed study and project work in web development, leading to a role at Hostelling International in 2019.

VARIOUS ROLES IN THE PHARMACEUTICAL INDUSTRY:

- **AYMES NUTRITION** - Key account manager *Sep 2016 - Feb 2018*
- **GLAXO SMITH KLINE** - Vaccines account manager March 2004 - August 2016

EARLIER CAREER

JANSSEN-CILAG *Specialist Medical Representative*

HART LIMITED: *Sales Representative*

SOUTH AFRICAN MILITARY: *Military service - Operational Medic*

EDUCATION

Diploma in Sales Management - *Damelin College, South Africa*

Secondary School - *Damelin College, South Africa*